

## Comparison of Adjectives

- 1. Positive Degree** When only one case is there.  
e.g. - Meerut is a *big* city.
- 2. Comparative Degree** When two cases are there.  
e.g. - Meerut is *bigger* than Ghaziabad.  
- She is *better* than anybody else in the school.
- 3. Superlative Degree** When more than two cases are there.  
e.g. - Meerut is the *biggest* city of West Uttar Pradesh.  
- He is the *most corrupt* politician of all in the country.

## Confusing Words

| Word                                 | Meaning                                                                                                                                                                                              | Example                                                                                                                                                                                                                      |
|--------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Later/<br>Latter/<br>Latest/<br>Last | 'Later' and 'latest' refer to time.<br>'Latter' and 'last' refer to position.<br>Latter : Former (opposite)<br>Last : First (opposite)<br>Later : Earlier (opposite)<br>Latest : Earliest (opposite) | Tempest was the <i>last/latest</i> play of Shakespeare.<br>What is the <i>last /latest</i> news?<br>He came <i>latter /later</i> than me.<br>The first half of the movie was very entertaining but the <i>latter</i> wasn't. |
| Elder/<br>Eldest                     | For blood relations only.                                                                                                                                                                            | I am his <i>elder</i> brother.                                                                                                                                                                                               |
| Old/<br>Older/<br>Oldest             | For both persons and things.                                                                                                                                                                         | My friend is <i>older</i> than me.                                                                                                                                                                                           |
| Farther                              | Geographical distance (comparative degree). Its superlative is 'farthest'.                                                                                                                           | Mumbai is <i>farther</i> than Gwalior. (✗)<br>Mumbai is <i>farther</i> than Gwalior from Meerut. (✓)                                                                                                                         |
| Further                              | Besides (in addition to)                                                                                                                                                                             | Kanyakumari is the <i>farthest</i> place in the South. (✓)<br>I would like to add <i>further</i> meaning to the studies. (✓)                                                                                                 |
| Nearest                              | It shows distance                                                                                                                                                                                    | The <i>nearest</i> post-office is <i>next</i> to the college.                                                                                                                                                                |
| Next                                 | It shows position                                                                                                                                                                                    |                                                                                                                                                                                                                              |

## Rules of Degrees

- Double comparative and double superlative are not used together.  
e.g. - She is the *most prettiest* girl. (✗)  
- She is the *prettiest* girl. (✓)  
- This boy is *more sweeter* than that boy. (✗)  
- This boy is *sweeter* than that boy. (✓)
- The Adjective ending in *-er* (e.g. wiser) should be used as 'more wise' while comparing two qualities of the same person or thing.  
e.g. - He is ~~wiser~~/more *wise* than strong.  
- He is ~~more wise~~/wiser than his brother.
- In comparative cases, 'other' is used with than.  
e.g. - He is *more* intelligent than his classmates. (✗)  
- He is *more* intelligent than his *other* classmates. (✓)  
- He is *stronger* than any person in the class. (✗)  
- He is *stronger* than any *other* person in the class. (✓)  
- This boy (*who has come from outside*) is *more* intelligent than any other boy in the class. (✓)  
- The Nile is *longer* than any river in the world. (✗)  
- The Nile is *longer* than any *other* river in the world. (✓)
- In superlative cases, *other* is not used.  
e.g. - Samudragupta was the most powerful of all kings of his time.
- Adjectives expressing qualities, that do not have different degrees, cannot be compared.  
e.g. - Perfect, complete, circular, finish, square, empty, impossible, enough, full, unique, wonderful, marvelous, excellent, ultimate.  
- This glass is *more* full than that glass. (✗)  
- I have had *more* than enough. (✗)
- Similar things should be compared when we compare two things.  
e.g. - The climate of Dehradun is better *than* Meerut. (✗)  
- The climate of Dehradun is better *than* that of Meerut. (✓)  
- The pollution in Delhi is greater *than* any other city in India. (✗)  
- The pollution of Delhi is greater *than* that of any other city in India. (✓)
- The comparative degree is generally followed by 'than', but the following comparative adjectives are followed by the preposition 'to'.  
e.g. - Superior, inferior, junior, senior, prefer, preferable, elder, younger, prior, etc.  
- He is senior *to* me.  
- I prefer tea *to* coffee.  
- The Jallianwala massacre happened prior *to* the Non-Cooperation Movement.
- If there is a gradual increase, it is expressed with two comparatives and not with positives.  
e.g. - Indian fielding is getting *better and better* day-by-day.  
- He became *more and more* intelligent while studying.

9. When two adjectives qualify the same noun, both the adjectives should be represented in the same degree.  
 e.g. - Taj Mahal is the *most beautiful* and the *most sought-after* place in India.  
 - He is the *best* and *honest* minister of our time. (X)  
 - He is the *best* and the *most honest* minister of our time. (✓)
10. The adjectives 'little' and 'few' are not made to qualify the nouns, 'quantity' and 'number'. Instead 'small' should be used to qualify these nouns.  
 e.g. - Would you please lend me ~~a few~~/small number of books for a month?  
 - I asked him not to waste even ~~a little~~/small quantity of food.
11. Do not say 'two first' for 'first two'.  
 e.g. - I saw only the *two first* episodes of the serial. (X)  
 - I saw only the *first two* episodes of the serial. (✓)

12. When two adjectives in different degrees of comparison are used in the same sentence, each should be complete in itself.  
 e.g. - He is *as good* if not better than his brother. (X)  
 - He is *as good as* if not better than his brother. (✓)
13. *Worth* +  $V_1$  + *ing* is placed after the same noun it qualifies.  
 e.g. - Taj Mahal is a monument *worth visiting*.  
 - Computer is a commodity *worth buying*.

### Confusing Words

| Word   | Meaning          | Example                                                          |
|--------|------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Hard   | Difficult, tough | He studies <i>hard</i> . (i.e. works very hard in studies)       |
| Hardly | Rarely, a little | He <i>hardly</i> studies. (i.e. he rarely studies)               |
| Late   | Delay            | <i>Lately</i> he is coming <i>late</i> from the office.          |
| Lately | Now-a-days       |                                                                  |
| Near   | Close            | Although he was <i>near</i> the truck, he <i>nearly</i> escaped. |
| Nearly | Almost           |                                                                  |

### SPOTTING THE ERRORS SET 4

## ✓ ERRORS OF ADJECTIVE

**Directions** (Q. Nos. 1-20) Which part of the given sentences has an error? In case, there is no error, choose option (d).

- There were (a)/ no less than fifty persons (b)/ present in the room. (c)/ No error (d)
- Few remarks (a)/ that he made were (b)/ offensive to my friend. (c)/ No error (d)
- It is a (a)/ worth watching documentary (b)/ and you must not miss it. (c)/ No error (d)
- Of all the students (a)/ Rita was less worried (b)/ when the date for the annual examination was announced. (c)/ No error (d)
- Even the most perfect person (a)/ in the world is said to have erred (b)/ when there was time to perform. (c)/ No error (d)
- In the opinion of everyone (a)/ she is wiser (b)/ than beautiful. (c)/ No error (d)
- The tiger is (a)/ as swift as (b)/ any animal. (c)/ No error (d)
- He had to cut a sorry figure (a)/ when he realised that he had (b)/ no any money in his purse. (c)/ No error (d)
- Of the three ministers (a)/ who do you think (b)/ is going to prove more successful? (c)/ No error (d)
- She is the best (a)/ and beautiful girl (b)/ of our class. (c)/ No error (d)
- I requested him (a)/ to lend me few books (b)/ that might help me in my studies. (c)/ No error (d)
- He is the tallest (a)/ than anybody (b)/ in the school. (c)/ No error (d)
- I was surprised (a)/ to see her speak (b)/ with somewhat anger. (c)/ No error (d)
- My brother is elder (a)/ than me although (b)/ he looks younger. (c)/ No error (d)
- Little care on your part (a)/ would have made you (b)/ more successful than your friend. (c)/ No error (d)
- Privatisation offers the most ideal situation (a)/ for consumers because private sector (b)/ is very conscious of quality. (c)/ No error
- She is better than (a)/ any girl that studies (b)/ in our institute. (c)/ No error (d)
- The latest chapter of this novel (a)/ is the most comprehensive of all (b)/ the chapters in the book. (c)/ No error (d)

19. She was not punished (a)/ though she came (b)/ latter than I. (c)/ No error (d)
20. Neither she is intelligent (a)/ nor hard working (b)/ and still she expects to secure first class. (c)/ No error (d)
21. It is all the more better (a)/ if you work (b)/ in my company. (c)/ No error (d)
22. It was bitter cold (a)/ so we preferred (b)/ not to go out that morning. (c)/ No error (d)
23. No animal (a)/ is as sacred to the Hindus (b)/ as the cow is. (c)/ No error (d)
24. There is no name (a)/ more glorious than Sardar Patel (b)/ in the history of India. (c)/ No error (d)
25. It very often happens (a)/ that a man who talks most (b)/ does less. (c)/ No error (d)
26. From all accounts I learn that (a)/ he is the best and honest member (b)/ of the new cabinet. (c)/ No error (d)
27. The flood situation (a)/ this year is worst than (b)/ that prevailed in the last year. (c)/ No error (d)
28. Geometry and Drawing (a)/ are more easier than (b)/ Geography and Social Studies. (c)/ No error (d)
29. Of all the friends (a)/ I have had (b)/ he is the most helpful and less arrogant. (c)/ No error (d)
30. My uncle forbade me (a)/ not to go through (b)/ the contents of his letter. (c)/ No error (d)

## > EXPLANATIONS

1. (b) 'No fewer than' should be replaced by 'no less than' to make the sentence meaningful.
2. (a) 'A few' would be used in the sentence instead of 'Few'.
3. (b) The usage of 'worth watching documentary' is incorrect. The correct usage will be 'documentary worth watching.'
4. (b) 'Least worried' should be replaced by 'less worried' to make the sentence meaningful.
5. (a) 'Most perfect' should be replaced by 'perfect' to make the sentence meaningful.
6. (b) 'Wiser' in the given sentence should be replaced by 'more wise'.
7. (c) To make the sentence grammatically correct, we need to add 'other' after the word 'any'.
8. (c) The word 'any' in the given sentence is not needed. So, we will delete 'any' from the sentence.
9. (c) 'More successful' is going to be replaced by 'most successful' to make the sentence meaningful.
10. (b) 'Beautiful' should be changed to 'most beautiful' to make the sentence grammatically correct.
11. (b) 'Few' means 'nothing'. So, we will use 'a few' in the given sentence to make it meaningful.
12. (b) 'Of all' is used instead of 'than anybody' to make the sentence meaningful.
13. (c) 'Somewhat' does not make sense with 'anger'. So, we would use 'some' instead of 'somewhat'.
14. (b) 'Elder to me' would be the correct usage.
15. (a) 'Little' should be replaced by 'A little'.
16. (a) Adjectives like 'ideal' do not have degrees. So, we would remove 'most' from the sentence.
17. (b) 'Other' should be added after 'any' to make the sentence grammatically correct.
18. (a) 'Latest' should be replaced by 'last' to make the sentence meaningful.
19. (c) 'Latter' should be changed to 'later' to make the sentence correct.
20. (a) 'Neither is she intelligent' should be replaced by 'Neither she is intelligent'.
21. (a) 'More' does not go with 'better'. So, we remove 'all the more' from the sentence.
22. (a) We need to change 'bitter' to 'bitterly' to make the sentence meaningful.
23. (a) We should add 'other' after 'No' to make the sentence grammatically correct.
24. (a) We should add 'other' after 'no' to make the sentence grammatically correct.
25. (c) 'Less' should be replaced by 'least' to make the sentence correct.
26. (b) 'Honest' needs to be changed to 'most honest' because as per the rule all the adjectives in a sentences should be of the same degree.
27. (b) When two things are compared the comparative degree is used. So, we would change 'worst' to 'worse'.
28. (b) 'More' does not go with 'easier'. So, we would remove it.
29. (c) 'Less' should be replaced by 'least' to make the sentence correct.
30. (b) As two negative words cannot go together. So, we would remove 'not'. ('Forbade' is also a negative word)

## ARTICLES

Articles are the members of the determiners family. 'A, An and The' are articles. Articles are used before nouns.

- e.g. - My brother is *a* businessman.  
 - An apple *a* day keeps the doctor away.

Here, 'a' is an article which is used before the noun (businessman) and 'an' is an article which is used before the noun 'apple'.

### Indefinite Articles

- Indefinite article 'A' is used before the words starting with the consonants.
- Indefinite article 'An' is used with the words starting with the vowel sound. (a, e, i, o, u)
  - e.g. - *An* umbrella is kept there.
  - *A* European lives in our colony.
  - Meerut has *a* university.
  - *An* honest and hardworking person always succeeds in life.
  - *An* hour is left.
  - *An* MA, *An* SP, *An* LLB

#### Use of Indefinite Articles

- (a) Before a common noun in singular to suggest the sense of one.
  - e.g. - Twelve inches make *a* foot.
  - There is *a* fan in the room.
  - *A* man is standing on the road.
- (b) Before a common noun in singular to suggest the vague sense of a certain or any.
  - e.g. - *A* book is kept there.
- (c) To make a common noun of a proper noun.  
 In this case, both definite and/or indefinite article can be used according to the case.
  - e.g. - Ajay is *a* Sherlock Holmes of our class.
  - Samudragupta was *the* Napoleon of India.
- (d) In the sense of each, every or per.
  - e.g. - The doctor advised the patient to take the medicine twice *a* day.
  - He studies for two hours *a* day.
- (e) In exclamations before singular countable nouns.
  - e.g. - What *a* shot!
  - What *a* beautiful girl!

### Definite Article

#### Use of Definite Article 'The'

- (a) When we speak of a particular person or thing or one already referred to.
  - e.g. - *The* book is kept there.
  - *The* CD of that movie is available in *the* market.

- *The* book you mentioned is available in *the* store.
  - *The* pleasant weather is inviting us outside.
  - (b) Before the names of physical features in Geography.
    - e.g. - *The* Himalayas, *The* Ganges, *The* Indian Ocean, etc.
    - However, if the reference is to a Single Island or a Single Mountain, 'the' is not used.
      - e.g. - *The* Kanchenjunga is the highest peak of (X) the Himalayas in India.
      - Kanchenjunga is the highest peak of the (✓) Himalayas in India.
      - *The* North Andaman is a part of the (X) Andaman group of islands.
      - North Andaman is a part of the (✓) Andaman group of islands.
  - (c) Before common nouns which are names of things unique or of their kind.
    - e.g. - *The* Sun, *The* Moon, *The* Earth, *The* Sky.
  - (d) Before the names of countries which show federation.
    - e.g. - *The* United States of America, *The* United Kingdom, *The* Republic of Korea, *The* Republic of South Africa, etc.
- Exception** The Netherlands, The Hague
- (e) Before the names of religious and mythological books, newspapers, magazines, journals, etc.
    - e.g. - *The* Bible, *The* India Today, *The* Times of India, etc
  - (f) Before Superlatives.
    - e.g. - I am *the* best.
    - He is *the* cleverest.
  - (g) As an adverb with a comparative.
    - e.g. - *The* more, *the* merrier.
    - *The* sooner, *the* better.
    - *The* higher you go, *the* colder it is.
  - (h) Before terms denoting Nationality, Community and Castes.
    - e.g. - *The* Australians, *The* Indians, *The* Hindus, etc
  - (i) Before historic events.
    - e.g. - *The* 1st Battle of Panipat, *The* Revolt of 1857, *The* Quit India Movement, *The* Gulf War, etc.
  - (j) Before musical instruments.
    - e.g. - I can play *the* flute very well.
    - Ustad Amjad Ali Khan plays *the* sarod.

- (k) Before an adjective when it represents a class of a people.  
e.g. - *The* rich should help *the* poor.  
- *The* old should be respected by *the* young.
- (l) Before a unit of measurement.  
e.g. - Cloth is sold by *the* metre.  
- Bananas are sold by *the* dozen.
- (m) Before a common noun to give the force of superlative.  
e.g. - He is *the* man.  
- This is *the* thing to do.
- (n) Before the adjectives 'same' and 'whole' and after the adjectives 'all' and 'both'.  
e.g. - He is *the same* person that I saw yesterday.  
- *The whole* class performed splendidly.  
- *All the* boys passed with flying colours.  
- *Both the* friends were present there.
- (o) Before a common noun to give it the meaning of an abstract noun.  
e.g. - *The* moralist in Gandhi revolted against injustice.  
- *The* judge in him prevailed upon the father and he sentenced his son to death.
- (p) Before various Cups and Trophies.  
e.g. - Sri Lanka has won *the* Asia Cup.  
- Almost all countries participate in *the* Olympics.
- (q) Before comparative degree in case of a choice.  
e.g. - He is *the* stronger of the two friends.
- Man is immortal. (✓)  
- *The* tiger is the national animal of India. (✗)  
- Tiger is the national animal of India. (✓)
- (d) Before the noun following 'kind of'.  
e.g. - What kind of *a* person you are? (✗)  
- What kind of person you are? (✓)  
- What kind of *a* book is it? (✗)  
- What kind of book is it? (✓)
- (e) Before uncountable nouns.  
e.g. - He gave me *advice*.  
- He passed on *information* to me.
- (f) Before school, college, home, church, temple, sea, work, bed, table, hospital, market, prison, court.  
However, when their purpose is thought of rather than the actual building, 'the' is used.  
e.g. - I go to *church* every Sunday.  
- I go to *bed* early these days.
- (g) Before names of diseases.  
e.g. - *AIDS* can be prevented using safety measures.  
- *Cancer* can be treated if detected early.
- (h) Before regular meals except when preceded by an Adjective.  
e.g. - I usually take *breakfast* at 9 o'clock.  
- We should take *dinner* atleast two hours before the sleeping time to avoid indigestion.  
- They gave us a sumptuous *lunch*.
- (i) Before modes of travel.  
e.g. - He will go by *air*.  
- Journey by *road* takes time.
- (j) Before names of relations like uncle, mother, father, etc.  
e.g. - *Uncle* will come tomorrow.  
- *Father* is working on a project.
- (k) Before adjectives used as nouns signifying a language or colours.  
e.g. - He doesn't know Hindi, but he knows *English*.  
- I like *red and blue*.
- (l) When two or more descriptive adjectives qualifying the same noun are connected by 'and', the Article is used before the first adjective only.  
e.g. - It is *a* Hindi and English Dictionary.  
(Here, the dictionary is one).
- (m) When two or more adjectives qualify different nouns, expressed or understood, the Article is used before each adjective.  
e.g. - *The* inner and *the* outer wall were both strongly defended.  
- He possesses *a* black dog and *a* white bitch.

## Omission of Articles

- (a) Before proper nouns.  
e.g. - *The* New Delhi is the capital of India. (✗)
- (b) Before material noun and abstract noun used in general sense.  
e.g. - The building is made up of *the* brick and *the* stone. (✗)  
- The building is made up of brick and stone. (✓)  
- I have *the* love for you. (✗)  
- I have love for you. (✓)  
- *The* care of the old is necessary. (✗)  
- Care of the old is necessary. (✓)
- However, if the material noun and abstract noun show some specific cases, article should be used.  
e.g. - *The* stone of Kota is of good quality.  
- *The* love I have for you is unconditional and infinite.
- (c) Before a noun used in its widest sense.  
e.g. - *The* science is a subject based on facts. (✗)  
- Science is a subject based on facts. (✓)  
- *The* man is immortal. (✗)